



Once a Roman colony, traces of Roman architecture are spread across the city, especially around the central city area



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markets, is a ten-minute walk from the Cathedral. Almost 100 years old, the market stalls sell a wide range of ingredients and local handicrafts—ranging from fresh meats and cheese to spice mixes. There are also stalls selling fruit cups and juices—the orange juice made from Valencia oranges is a must try. Further inside you'll find food stalls selling local delicacies which are great for a quick bite.

Food is an integral part of the city's history. Paella, one of Spain's most popular contributions to the culinary world, was created here and every restaurant has their own version of this classic dish of rice cooked with meat or seafood. The city also has its own signature cocktail—Agua de Valencia—made from, what else, but Valencian oranges.

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For a change in scene, take a 20-minute tram ride to Malvarrosa beach. You can lounge on the beach or by one of the many eateries dotting the promenade or take a quick dip in the calm Mediterranean waters. You could also drive a bit further out to Albufera national park—the largest freshwater lagoon and wetlands in Spain. The best way to explore the area is to take a boat ride around the lagoon. The sunset trips tend to be popular but go earlier if you want to go birdwatching—the area attracts up to 300 different species through the year, especially waterfowl and flamingos.

Wind down over tapas back in the city or at one of the other food markets; it's hard to go wrong with food here. Whether it's culture, cuisine or outdoor activities, Valencia ticks all the boxes! **BT**